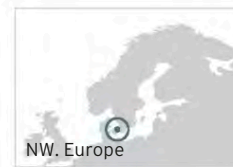




Frederiksborg Castle

The Renaissance-style residence of King Christian IV of Denmark-Norway, now the Danish Museum of National History



△ THE KNIGHTS' HALL

The spacious central hall, like the rest of the interior of the castle, is rich in elaborate architectural features. It is ornately decorated in the Baroque style and contains a wealth of tapestries and artwork.

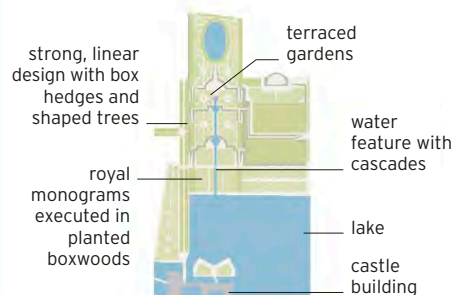
Built in the early 17th century, the imposing Frederiksborg Castle stands on one of the three small islands in the Castle Lake at Hillerød, north of Copenhagen. The main building, the King's Wing, is symmetrical, with a quadrangle at its center. However, the complex as a whole, which includes the Chapel Wing, Princess's Wing, and Terrace Wing, is not symmetrical.

Castle to museum

The buildings are primarily made of red brick, with sandstone decoration. They have steep roofs and gables in the Dutch Renaissance style but also feature several towers and spires, and a wealth of sculpted decorations celebrating the reign of King Christian IV (r.1588–1648). The castle was almost completely destroyed by a fire in 1859 but was reconstructed as nearly as possible to the original design, inside and out. Once completed, the castle was opened to the public as a museum in 1882.

BAROQUE GARDEN

Frederiksborg Castle stands in extensive grounds, originally a park for hunting deer. Frederik IV (r.1699–1730) commissioned court gardener Johan Cornelius Krieger to create a formal garden to complement the Baroque style of the castle. This featured a fountain and cascades running through terraces of geometric formal flowerbeds.



△ THE KING'S WING

Overlooking the lake and gardens, the facade of the main castle building combines the seriousness of the Dutch Renaissance style with Baroque ornamentation and flourishes.